

**SATYADHEESH**
सत्याधीश

UPSC WEEKLY DETAILED NOTES

Current Affairs • Week 40 • 28 Sep – 4 Oct 2026**50**

NOTES

35

STORIES MERGED

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PAPER MIX

CONTENTS**Every note, grouped by paper****GS1 History • Society • Geography** 3 notes

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Geography 1

GS2 Polity • Governance • Social Justice • IR 23 notes

Polity & Constitution 9

Governance 1

Social Justice 2

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GS3 Economy • S&T • Environment • Security 24 notes

Economy 9

Agriculture 1

Science & Technology 7

Environment & Ecology 3

Internal Security 4

HOW EACH NOTE READS

Why in news → facts to remember → a Mains question with keywords. Duplicate stories are merged.

SHORT ON TIME?

The 5-page **Brief** has the stories that matter most, plus a quiz. Same day, same notes.

History & Culture

2

ANCIENT & MEDIEVAL INDIA

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M

29 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127859

NCERT Replaces European Revolutions with Medieval India History in Class 9 Textbook

WHY IN NEWS NCERT released a new Class 9 Social Science textbook replacing European revolutions with Indian medieval resistance movements to emphasize indigenous history.

- BODY** | NCERT: National Council of Educational Research and Training is the apex body for school education curriculum in India
- FACT** | Jat Uprising: A significant regional resistance movement occurred in 1669
- FACT** | The new curriculum focuses on the period between 1,000 and 1,700 CE

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of decolonizing the Indian school curriculum by shifting focus from Western revolutions to indigenous medieval resistance movements.

USE: decolonization pedagogical shift indigenous history historical narrative cultural identity

HERITAGE SITES, UNESCO & GI TAGS

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30 Sep · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128055

Five new sites, including Udaigiri Caves, added to India's UNESCO World Heritage tentative list

WHY IN NEWS The Government of India added five new sites, including the Udaigiri Caves and Satyagraha sites, to the UNESCO World Heritage tentative list.

- BODY** | UNESCO: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- PLACE** | Udaigiri Caves: Located in the state of Madhya Pradesh
- FACT** | India's total tentative list count: 78 sites
- PLACE** | Ginnorgarh Fort: Located in the state of Rajasthan

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of the UNESCO World Heritage status in promoting cultural preservation and boosting heritage tourism in India.

USE: cultural heritage UNESCO heritage tourism preservation transnational proposal

Geography

1

PLACES IN NEWS / MAPPING

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129419

India identifies 28 strategic places and geographical features on official Survey of India map

WHY IN NEWS The Government of India formally identified 28 strategic places and geographical features on the official Survey of India map to ensure accurate recognition of territory.

- PLACE** | Zorawar Peak and Kanishka Peak are strategic geographical features in the Ladakh region.
- PLACE** | The Survey of India (Sol) is the national survey and mapping agency of India.
- FACT** | A total of 28 strategic places and geographical features were identified on October 2, 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of accurate cartographic representation in safeguarding India's territorial integrity and managing border security in high-altitude regions.

USE: Cartographic sovereignty Territorial integrity Strategic mapping Border management Geospatial data

Polity & Constitution

9

JUDICIARY & LANDMARK JUDGMENTS

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28 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127323

Supreme Court Questions How Minors Can Have Social Media Accounts

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court questioned the legality of minors holding social media accounts, noting that contracts entered by minors are void ab initio.

- BODY** | Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
- FACT** | Minors are legally incompetent to enter into binding contracts in India.
- FACT** | The court directed an 18-year age threshold for social media memberships.

MAINS Q Discuss the legal and ethical challenges posed by the digital presence of minors and the necessity of robust regulatory frameworks to ensure child safety online.

USE: void ab initio digital safeguards legal incompetence regulatory framework child protection

JUDICIARY & LANDMARK JUDGMENTS

P

2 REPORTS MERGED

28 Sep · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127339

Supreme Court Collegium recommends three High Court Chiefs for top judge roles

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court Collegium recommended three High Court Chief Justices for elevation to the Supreme Court, highlighting the judicial appointment process.

- BODY** | The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- POST** | The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- FACT** | The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.

MAINS Q Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary?

USE: Judicial Independence Transparency Collegium System Separation of Powers

CONSTITUTION, AMENDMENTS & BASIC STRUCTURE

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2 REPORTS MERGED

28 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127345

HLCDC Seeks 15-Year Religion-Wise Data, Struggling States Face Constitutional Hurdles

WHY IN NEWS The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) requested religion-wise data from states, sparking a debate on the constitutionality of such data collection.

- BODY** | HLCDC: High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs
- FACT** | The committee seeks data spanning a 15-year period to analyze demographic trends
- PLACE** | The committee visited Jammu and is scheduled to visit Maharashtra

MAINS Q Discuss the constitutional and ethical implications of collecting religion-based demographic data by the state. Does such data collection compromise the principle of secularism?

USE: Secularism Data Privacy Demographic Change Constitutional Morality Communal Harmony

Supreme Court Orders Delhi Police to Audit Lighting, CCTV After Recent Rapes

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of sexual assault incidents in Delhi-NCR, directing the Delhi Police to audit infrastructure and enhance patrolling to ensure the right to life and dignity.

CONSTITUTION	Article 21: Guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, which includes the right to live with dignity.
BODY	Delhi Police: The primary law enforcement agency for the National Capital Territory of Delhi.
FACT	The court mandated a four-week timeline for the audit of lighting and CCTV coverage.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of the judiciary in ensuring the right to safety and dignity for women in urban spaces. How can proactive policing mitigate crimes against women?

USE: Suo motu cognizance Right to dignity Public safety Vulnerability mapping Judicial oversight

Ladakh Demands Sixth Schedule Status, MHA Proposes Directly Elected Body

WHY IN NEWS The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) proposed a directly elected legislative body for Ladakh as an alternative to the Sixth Schedule status demanded by locals.

CONSTITUTION	Sixth Schedule: Provides autonomy to tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
BODY	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA): Responsible for internal security and border management.
FACT	Article 371-K: Proposed provision to provide special provisions for Ladakh.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges of balancing regional autonomy with national security concerns in strategically sensitive border regions like Ladakh.

USE: Regional Autonomy National Security Federalism Strategic Depth Democratic Decentralization

In August 2026, the Supreme Court asked Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court directed Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes following a PIL regarding surveillance and privacy rights.

BODY	Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
S&T	Deepfakes: Synthetic media in which a person in an existing image or video is replaced by someone else's likeness.
S&T	Doxxing: The act of publicly revealing private personal information about an individual without consent.
FACT	Special Intensive Revision (SIR): A process used by the Election Commission for voter list updates.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges posed by deepfakes and doxxing to the right to privacy and the necessity of a robust legal framework to regulate AI-driven surveillance.

USE: Right to Privacy Surveillance Digital Integrity Judicial Oversight Cyber Ethics

Election Chief Faces Petition for Database Tampering, Voter Disenfranchisement

WHY IN NEWS A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent audit of Election Commission databases and the removal of statutory immunity for the CEC over alleged electoral roll tampering.

ACT / BILL	Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
CONSTITUTION	Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
BODY	Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.
FACT	Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950: Deals with offences related to electoral rolls.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India.

USE: Electoral Integrity Statutory Immunity Disenfranchisement Constitutional Democracy Transparency

Supreme Court to Examine Threat to Press Freedom in The Hindu Case

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court will examine the conflict between legislative privileges and freedom of the press in a 2003 case involving *The Hindu* and the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

CONSTITUTION	Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
CONSTITUTION	Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
BODY	Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.

MAINS Q Examine the constitutional conflict between the privileges of the legislature and the fundamental right to freedom of the press in India.

USE: Freedom of Press Legislative Privilege Harmonious Construction Fundamental Rights Judicial Review

EC directs officers to enroll eligible voters after 13.3 crore names deleted

WHY IN NEWS The Election Commission of India directed Chief Electoral Officers to conduct a special drive to re-enroll eligible voters following the deletion of 13.3 crore names from voter lists.

BODY	Election Commission of India (ECI) is the constitutional body responsible for administering elections to Parliament and State Legislatures.
FACT	Approximately 13.3 crore names were deleted from voter lists leading to the current rectification drive.
FACT	Form 6 is the specific application form used for the enrollment of new voters in the electoral roll.
POST	Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) are the primary state-level authorities responsible for the conduct of elections in their respective States/UTs.

MAINS Q Examine the challenges in maintaining an accurate and inclusive electoral roll in India and suggest measures to ensure universal suffrage.

USE: Universal Adult Franchise Electoral Roll Constitutional Mandate Inclusivity Demographic Accuracy

Union Government Seeks Supreme Court Stay on Great Nicobar Island Project Petitions

WHY IN NEWS The Union government moved the Supreme Court to stay hearings on the ₹92,000–crore Great Nicobar project due to allegations of violating the Forest Rights Act (FRA).

ACT / BILL	Forest Rights Act (FRA): Legislation providing forest–dwelling communities with legal rights over forest land.
FACT	Great Nicobar Project: A mega–infrastructure project estimated at ₹92,000 crore.
PLACE	Great Nicobar Island: An island in the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in balancing large-scale infrastructure development with the protection of tribal rights and forest conservation under the Forest Rights Act.

USE:

Statutory compliance

Tribal rights

Infrastructure development

Judicial review

Environmental governance

Social Justice

India Had 50 Million Schoolchildren Without Sanitation in 2025: WHO/UNICEF Report

WHY IN NEWS A WHO/UNICEF report highlights that 50 million Indian schoolchildren still lack sanitation services despite progress under the Swachh Bharat Mission.

BODY	WHO and UNICEF are the primary bodies responsible for the report on global school sanitation.
SCHEME	Swachh Bharat Mission was launched in 2014 to improve sanitation and hygiene.
FACT	India has 50 million schoolchildren without sanitation services as of 2025.
FACT	Only 12 million Indian children lack access to basic drinking water in schools.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in achieving universal sanitation in rural schools and suggest measures to bridge the rural-urban hygiene gap in India.

USE:

sanitation equity

public health

rural–urban divide

infrastructure gap

Swachh Bharat Mission

India's Orphan Drug Potential: 1,004 Rare Disorders, \$100,000+ Treatments Await Solutions

WHY IN NEWS The article highlights India's potential to become a global hub for orphan drug manufacturing to address 1,004 rare genetic disorders.

ACT / BILL	Orphan Drug Act (1983) provides tax breaks and market exclusivity for rare disease drugs
FACT	India supports rare disease patients with subsidies up to Rs 50 lakh
FACT	U.S. approved 1,122 orphan drugs post–Act implementation by 2022

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges and opportunities for India in developing a robust ecosystem for orphan drugs to address the healthcare needs of patients with rare diseases.

USE:

orphan drugs

rare diseases

pharmaceutical manufacturing

healthcare accessibility

policy incentives

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

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2 REPORTS MERGED

29 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127405

UAE to invest additional \$25 billion in India, aiming for \$100 billion total

WHY IN NEWS The UAE announced a \$25 billion investment in India's infrastructure and technology sectors, aiming to reach a \$100 billion total investment target.

- FACT** | UAE's total investment target in India: \$100 billion
- FACT** | Target bilateral trade between India and UAE: \$200 billion by 2032
- FACT** | New investment tranche announced: \$25 billion
- FACT** | Key sectors for cooperation: Ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology, and financial services

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of India's deepening economic and technological ties with the UAE in the context of India's 'Look West' policy and energy security.

USE: Bilateral trade Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Energy security Strategic partnership Infrastructure development

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

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29 Sep · Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/127741

Houthis Capture Yemen Ports with IRGC Help, Control Strategic Strait

WHY IN NEWS Houthi rebels captured key Yemeni ports with reported IRGC assistance, threatening maritime security in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait.

- PLACE** | Bab al-Mandeb Strait: A strategic maritime choke point connecting the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden.
- FACT** | Ansar Allah (Houthis): A militant group in Yemen supported by Iran.
- S&T** | IRGC: The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps is an elite branch of the Iranian Armed Forces.

MAINS Q Analyze the impact of the Houthi-led maritime disruptions on global trade routes and India's energy security.

USE: maritime security choke point proxy warfare energy security geopolitics

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

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29 Sep · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127753

India Talks with China to Use Xinjiang Airspace; Flights Set to Resume

WHY IN NEWS India and China are negotiating the use of Xinjiang airspace as an alternative route for Indian airlines following Pakistan's airspace ban.

- FACT** | China Southern Airlines resumed direct flights between Guangzhou and New Delhi from September 21.
- PLACE** | Hotan is a city in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region of China.
- FACT** | IndiGo and Air India have resumed services to China as part of restored air links.

MAINS Q Discuss how the restoration of air connectivity and airspace negotiations between India and China reflect the evolving dynamics of bilateral relations and regional logistics.

USE: bilateral diplomacy airspace sovereignty regional connectivity strategic logistics

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

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2 REPORTS MERGED

29 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127916

Japan urges India to speed up UNICORN radar deal amid Quad naval plans

WHY IN NEWS Japan urged India to fast-track the UNICORN naval radar agreement to enhance maritime security and military collaboration under FOIP principles.

- INTL. ORG** | FOIP: Free and Open Indo-Pacific is a strategic framework for maritime security and regional cooperation.
- FACT** | The UNICORN naval radar agreement is a bilateral defense cooperation between India and Japan.
- PLACE** | The Sea of Japan is a key maritime zone for Quad naval exercises.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of the UNICORN naval radar agreement and the FOIP framework in strengthening India-Japan maritime security cooperation.

USE: maritime security strategic partnership FOIP defense cooperation regional stability

Pakistan hosts SCO preparatory meeting; India attends amid Kashmir tensions

WHY IN NEWS India participated in an SCO preparatory meeting in Islamabad for the first time since Operation Sindoor, highlighting complex dynamics between multilateral cooperation and bilateral tensions.

INTL. ORG	SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance.
FACT	Pakistan is scheduled to host the SCO Summit in August 2027.
PLACE	Islamabad: Capital of Pakistan where the preparatory meeting was held.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges India faces in balancing multilateral engagements within the SCO while navigating bilateral tensions and security concerns in the region.

USE: multilateralism strategic autonomy regional security bilateral friction

US pauses record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as trade bargaining chip

WHY IN NEWS The US paused a record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan during a summit with China as a trade bargaining chip, signaling a shift in US-China-India dynamics.

FACT	The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as a bargaining chip during negotiations with China.
FACT	The US and China extended their trade truce by two months following the Washington summit.
PLACE	Donald Trump is scheduled to visit China for the APEC summit in November 2025.
PLACE	Xi Jinping is scheduled to attend the G20 summit in Miami in December 2025.
FACT	India faced a 50% tariff hike on its goods by the US in August 2025.

MAINS Q Analyze how the shift in US-China relations towards 'managed competition' impacts India's strategic autonomy and its position in the Indo-Pacific region.

USE: Managed Competition Strategic Autonomy Indo-Pacific Trade Diplomacy Geopolitical Realignment

Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

WHY IN NEWS President Donald Trump signed the 'White House Accord on Super Intelligence' with major AI firms (Meta, Nvidia, Google, etc.) to establish voluntary guardrails and oversight for advanced AI development.

S&T	White House Accord on Super Intelligence: A voluntary pact between the US government and major AI firms for safety oversight.
S&T	OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic: Key private entities involved in the development of Large Language Models and Super Intelligence.
ACT / BILL	Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act: A legislative proposal aimed at prohibiting the development of super-intelligent AI systems.

MAINS Q Discuss the necessity of multi-stakeholder governance frameworks in regulating Artificial Super Intelligence to balance technological innovation with global safety standards.

USE: Algorithmic accountability Technological sovereignty Safety guardrails Multi-stakeholder governance Regulatory framework

Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

WHY IN NEWS PM Modi and Donald Trump held a telephone call to review bilateral ties and trade amidst discussions on the Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act.

- FACT** | The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes tariffs of up to 100% on specific imports.
- POST** | S. Jaishankar serves as the External Affairs Minister of India.
- BODY** | The act targets countries importing Russian oil as a means of economic pressure.

MAINS Q Analyze how the proposed Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act could impact India's strategic autonomy and its energy security goals.

USE: Strategic Autonomy Energy Security Trade Policy Geopolitical Pressure Tariff Regime

Russia warns NATO it will use entire arsenal including nuclear weapons over Kaliningrad blockade

WHY IN NEWS Russia issued a diplomatic memo to NATO threatening the use of its entire arsenal, including nuclear weapons, in response to potential blockades of the Kaliningrad exclave.

- PLACE** | Kaliningrad: A Russian exclave located on the Baltic Sea, bordering Poland and Lithuania.
- POST** | Mark Rutte: The current Secretary-General of NATO.
- FACT** | Russia's nuclear arsenal is the largest in the world, governed by various arms control treaties.

MAINS Q Analyze the implications of the escalating Russia-NATO tensions in the Baltic region on European security architecture and global nuclear non-proliferation norms.

USE: Nuclear Deterrence Exclave Collective Defense Geopolitical Friction Security Dilemma

Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes

WHY IN NEWS Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to negotiate an interim trade agreement amidst shifting U.S. tariff policies.

- POST** | Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- FACT** | Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- FACT** | India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh

MAINS Q Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition.

USE: Trade Liberalization Tariff Protectionism Bilateral Cooperation Trade Diplomacy Market Access

Maninder Sidhu and Piyush Goyal aim to scale Canada and India bilateral trade

WHY IN NEWS India and Canada have initiated the fifth round of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) negotiations to scale bilateral trade to USD 70 billion by 2031.

- FACT** | Target bilateral trade volume between India and Canada: USD 70 billion by 2031
- BODY** | CEPA: Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement being negotiated between India and Canada
- PLACE** | Ottawa: Location of the fifth round of CEPA negotiations starting October 5, 2024
- FACT** | Current bilateral trade baseline: USD 30 billion

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) in diversifying India's supply chains and enhancing its energy security through bilateral trade with Canada.

USE: Bilateral Trade Supply Chain Diversification Critical Minerals Economic Partnership Trade Liberalization

Economy

9

INDUSTRY, INVESTMENT & MSMEs

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30 Sep · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128134

India Aims for 10 GW Polysilicon by August to Cut China Dependence

WHY IN NEWS The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy is developing an incentive scheme to boost domestic polysilicon production to reduce India's heavy reliance on Chinese imports.

- FACT** | India's current solar module manufacturing capacity exceeds 213 GW.
- FACT** | Target for domestic polysilicon production is 30 GW by 2030.
- BODY** | Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is the nodal ministry for solar incentives.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of developing a domestic solar supply chain in India to achieve energy security and reduce import dependencies.

USE: Supply chain integration Energy security Import substitution Renewable energy infrastructure

INDUSTRY, INVESTMENT & MSMEs

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30 Sep · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128231

Centre notifies CAFE-3 norms: Fuel benchmark to drop 16.7% by 2031–32

WHY IN NEWS The Centre notified CAFE-3 norms for passenger vehicles to mandate a 16.7% reduction in fuel consumption benchmarks by 2031–32 to promote cleaner automotive technologies.

- FACT** | CAFE-3 fuel benchmark: 3.3273 litres per 100 km by 2031–32
- FACT** | Reference weight increase: From 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg under CAFE-3
- S&T** | Carbon Neutrality Factor (CNF): A mechanism providing concessions for eligible cleaner technologies
- FACT** | Implementation period: April 1, 2027, to March 31, 2032

MAINS Q Discuss how the CAFE-3 norms align with India's commitment to decarbonizing the transport sector while balancing industrial growth and technological adoption.

USE: Decarbonization Corporate Average Fuel Economy Carbon Neutrality Factor Regulatory Framework Sustainable Mobility

GROWTH, INFLATION & MACRO INDICATORS

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2 REPORTS MERGED

30 Sep · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128332

India to become "super-aged" by 2065 as fertility rate hits 1.9

WHY IN NEWS A Moody's report warns that India's rapid fertility decline (1.9) will lead to a 'super-aged' demographic status by 2065, posing a risk of aging before achieving high-income status.

- FACT** | India's current Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is 1.9.
- FACT** | India is projected to become 'super-aged' by the year 2065.
- FACT** | Annual births in India have dropped to 2.32 crore.
- FACT** | Replacement level fertility is generally considered to be 2.1 children per woman.

MAINS Q Discuss the economic implications of India's rapidly aging demographic profile and the necessity of increasing female labor force participation to sustain growth.

USE: Demographic Dividend Total Fertility Rate Dependency Ratio Super-aged Population Longevity

India proposes \$25 billion pool to support Deep Tech startups and reduce foreign dependence

WHY IN NEWS India proposed a \$25 billion fund to support Deep Tech startups to reduce reliance on foreign technology, as highlighted by the IVCA-Venture Intelligence Bharat DeepTech Report 2026.

- FACT** | Proposed Deep Tech fund size: \$25 billion
- BODY** | IVCA: Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association
- FACT** | Total funding recorded between 2015 and July 2026: \$11.4 billion
- FACT** | Number of Deep Tech deals recorded by July 2026: 957

MAINS Q Discuss how fostering a robust Deep Tech ecosystem can enhance India's technological sovereignty and reduce its dependence on foreign intellectual property.

USE: Technological Sovereignty Deep Tech Venture Capital Capital Formation Import Substitution

India's external debt rose \$15.4 billion to \$778.2 billion by end-June

WHY IN NEWS RBI data revealed a rise in India's external debt to \$778.2 billion by June 2024, reflecting the country's evolving debt-to-GDP dynamics.

- FACT** | India's total external debt reached \$778.2 billion by June 2024.
- FACT** | India's debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% as of June 2024.
- FACT** | August 2024 services trade exports were \$35.5 billion against \$18.9 billion imports.
- BODY** | The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the primary authority for monitoring external debt and debt-to-GDP ratios.

MAINS Q Analyze the factors influencing India's external debt dynamics and discuss the implications of a moderating debt-to-GDP ratio on India's macroeconomic stability.

USE: Debt-to-GDP ratio External debt Macroeconomic stability Current account Sovereign credit

India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04

WHY IN NEWS The Finance Ministry flagged risks to India's economy due to a 28.66% surge in crude oil prices in September and potential US-led trade restrictions on Russian crude.

- FACT** | India's crude oil basket price in September: \$116.04 per barrel
- FACT** | Real GDP growth rate in Q1 FY27: 7.8%
- FACT** | Indian crude basket composition: Sweet crude (Brent-based) and Sour crude (Oman and Dubai grades)
- FACT** | Manufacturing growth rate in Q1 FY27: 9.2%

MAINS Q Analyze how volatile global energy prices and geopolitical trade shifts impact India's fiscal stability and domestic inflation targets.

USE: Imported Inflation Energy Security Fiscal Risk Trade Volatility Supply Chain Resilience

80% of Mumbaikars refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000

WHY IN NEWS The Ministry of Finance notified a framework to introduce a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above ₹2,000, sparking consumer resistance and merchant pushback.

- FACT** | MDR of 0.4% applies to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI payments above ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026
- FACT** | MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above
- FACT** | Maharashtra accounted for 9.84% of UPI transactions by volume as of April 2026
- BODY** | NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) provides state-wise UPI transaction data

MAINS Q Discuss the economic implications of transitioning from a zero-MDR model to a fee-based structure for UPI payments on the digital economy and financial inclusion.

USE: Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) Digital Payments Financial Inclusion Transaction Costs UPI Framework

Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders

WHY IN NEWS The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas mandated that households lacking biometric Aadhaar authentication (BAA) will only receive 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices to ensure subsidy integrity.

- BODY** | Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL are the three major public sector oil marketing companies in India.
- FACT** | The mandate restricts households without BAA to 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices.
- POST** | The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas oversees the distribution of LPG subsidies.

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication in Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) schemes balances the objective of subsidy leakage prevention with the challenge of digital exclusion.

USE: Direct Benefit Transfer Digital Exclusion Subsidy Leakage eKYC Public Distribution System

Sarjjeet Singh Virk, Co-founder & MD of Shoonya

WHY IN NEWS SEBI's FY25-26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses, highlighting risks in retail participation in complex financial instruments.

- FACT** | 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses in the FY25-26 SEBI study
- FACT** | Options trading accounted for 92% of the total losses in equity derivatives
- FACT** | Transaction costs of Rs 24,859 crore impacted the profitability of 4.4 lakh traders
- BODY** | SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) is the primary regulator for the securities market in India

MAINS Q Discuss the risks associated with retail participation in complex derivative products and suggest measures to enhance investor protection in capital markets.

USE: Investor Protection Information Asymmetry Market Volatility Financial Literacy Regulatory Oversight

Modi cabinet approves rabi crop MSP hikes with ₹90,962 crore farmer payout

WHY IN NEWS The Union Cabinet approved increased Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for six Rabi crops for the 2027-28 marketing year to ensure farmer profitability.

- FACT** | Wheat MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹2,610 per quintal
- FACT** | Masur MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹7,390 per quintal
- BODY** | CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices) provides recommendations for MSP fixing
- FACT** | Total estimated farmer payout for 2027-28 rabi crops: ₹90,962 crore
- FACT** | Wheat production target for 2026-27 crop year: 121 million tonnes

MAINS Q Critically examine the role of Minimum Support Price (MSP) in ensuring food security and farmer welfare while addressing the fiscal implications on the national exchequer.

USE: Minimum Support Price Rabi Crops CACP Food Security Fiscal Policy

Science & Technology

HAL Excluded: Defence Ministry Picks Private Firms for AMCA Prototypes

WHY IN NEWS Defence Secretary RK Singh revealed that HAL was excluded from the AMCA prototype manufacturing project for the first time due to technical grounds, shifting focus toward private sector participation.

- S&T** | AMCA: India's indigenous Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft project.
- FACT** | First flight of the AMCA prototype is expected in September 2028.
- BODY** | HAL: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited is a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Defence.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of involving the private sector in the manufacturing of advanced indigenous defence technologies like the AMCA for India's self-reliance.

USE: Indigenisation Defence Manufacturing Strategic Autonomy Private Sector Participation Technology Transfer

ISRO and CNES are preparing to launch TRISHNA from Sriharikota in 2027

WHY IN NEWS ISRO and France's CNES are collaborating to launch the TRISHNA satellite in 2027 to map Earth's water resources and monitor the global water cycle.

- S&T** | TRISHNA: A joint satellite mission by ISRO (India) and CNES (France) scheduled for 2027.
- S&T** | TRISHNA's Orbit: Operates in a Sun-synchronous orbit at an altitude of more than 700 km.
- FACT** | TRISHNA Resolution: Aims to deliver a resolution better than 60 metres with multiple revisits per week.
- S&T** | Vikas Engine: India's major rockets carry a French legacy through the Viking engine, which was transformed into the Vikas engine.

MAINS Q Discuss how space-based remote sensing technologies can contribute to achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) related to water security and climate change mitigation.

USE: Remote Sensing Space Diplomacy Water Security Climate Resilience Technological Collaboration

Kaveri Derivative Engine Exceeds Target, Reaches 48.5 kN Thrust in Russian Trials

WHY IN NEWS DRDO's Kaveri Derivative Engine (KDE) exceeded its thrust target during high-altitude flight trials in Russia, marking a milestone for India's indigenous UCAV propulsion.

- S&T** | GTRE: Gas Turbine Research Establishment is a DRDO laboratory specializing in gas turbine engines.
- S&T** | KDE: Kaveri Derivative Engine is designed to power the Ghatak UCAV.
- POST** | CEMILAC: Centre for Military Airworthiness and Certification is the body responsible for certifying aircraft and engines.
- FACT** | The KDE achieved a peak dry thrust of 48.5 kN, exceeding the initial target of 46 kN.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of indigenous propulsion technology in achieving 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' in the aerospace and defence sector.

USE: indigenous technology propulsion systems strategic autonomy UCAV R&D

Omar Yaghi and team win Nobel Prize for extracting water in Death Valley

WHY IN NEWS Omar Yaghi and his team won the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for developing Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs) capable of extracting liquid water from arid air.

- S&T** | MOF-303: A Metal-Organic Framework (MOF) used for atmospheric water harvesting.
- POST** | Omar Yaghi: Saudi national and professor at UC Berkeley, winner of the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.
- PLACE** | Furnace Creek: Located in Death Valley National Park, used as a testing site for water extraction.
- FACT** | The device successfully extracted water from air with 14% humidity during the 2022 trials.

MAINS Q Discuss how advancements in Material Science, specifically Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs), can address global water scarcity in arid and semi-arid regions.

USE: Metal-Organic Frameworks Atmospheric Water Harvesting Material Science Water Scarcity Desalination Alternatives

IN-SPACe guidelines require Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads under Space Policy 2023

WHY IN NEWS IN-SPACe released guidelines under the Space Policy 2023 requiring Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads to ensure national security and treaty compliance.

- BODY** | IN-SPACe: Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre, the nodal agency for private sector space activities.
- FACT** | DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, currently listing 440 space startups.
- S&T** | Hosted-payloads: Instruments or equipment carried by a spacecraft and operated by a third party.
- POST** | Space Policy 2023: The overarching framework governing India's commercial space sector.

MAINS Q Discuss how the regulatory framework for hosted-payloads balances the promotion of private space exploration with national security and international treaty obligations.

USE: Regulatory Framework National Security Space Policy Private Participation Hosted-Payloads

Jessica Watkins becomes first Black woman to lead crew to orbit in record flight

WHY IN NEWS SpaceX successfully launched a four-person crew to the International Space Station (ISS) in a record-breaking 8-hour journey, featuring the first Black woman to lead a crew to orbit.

- S&T** | SpaceX: A private American aerospace manufacturer and space transportation company.
- PLACE** | Cape Canaveral Space Force Station: A primary spaceport located in Florida, USA.
- S&T** | International Space Station (ISS): A modular space station in low Earth orbit for scientific research.
- FACT** | The crew reached the ISS in a record-breaking 8-hour flight time.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of private-public partnerships in space exploration and their role in accelerating technological milestones for humanity.

USE: SpaceX ISS Aerospace Public-Private Partnership Orbital Mechanics

UNFCCC Executive Secretary praises Rs 1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

WHY IN NEWS UNFCCC Executive Secretary Simon Stiell praised India's approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) for its scale in evacuating renewable energy.

- FACT** | GEC-III total project outlay: Rs 1.86 lakh crore
- FACT** | Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) capacity: 50 GWh
- FACT** | Renewable energy evacuation target: 135 GW
- FACT** | Central Financial Assistance (CFA) for GEC-III: Rs 54,082 crore
- BODY** | UNFCCC: United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

MAINS Q Examine how the development of large-scale battery energy storage systems and transmission corridors can address the intermittency challenges of India's renewable energy transition.

USE: Renewable Energy Transition Grid Stability Energy Storage Systems Decarbonization Infrastructure Development

Environment & Ecology

3

Delhi bans non-compliant vehicles from November 1 under strict new Winter Action Plan

WHY IN NEWS The Delhi government and Ministry of Environment unveiled the Winter Action Plan 2026-27 to mitigate severe air pollution in the National Capital Region (NCR).

- BODY** | CAQM: Commission for Air Quality Management is a statutory body for air pollution management in NCR.
- BODY** | CPCB: Central Pollution Control Board is the statutory authority for pollution control in India.
- FACT** | ANPR: Automatic Number Plate Recognition systems are used to monitor non-compliant vehicles.
- PLACE** | NCR: National Capital Region includes Delhi and surrounding districts of Haryana, UP, and Rajasthan.

MAINS Q Discuss the effectiveness of multi-agency collaborative frameworks like the CAQM in tackling the recurring winter air pollution crisis in the National Capital Region.

USE: inter-agency collaboration mitigation strategies regulatory compliance urban air quality sustainable mobility

East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

WHY IN NEWS The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that the 2026 southwest monsoon was significantly below normal, with the East and Northeast regions recording their driest monsoon since 1901.

- FACT** | India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).
- S&T** | El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- BODY** | The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.
- FACT** | The southern peninsula recorded 542 mm of rain, the fourth lowest monsoon rainfall in that region since 1901.

MAINS Q Analyze the impact of El Nino and climate change on the variability of the Indian monsoon and its implications for food security.

USE: El Nino Monsoon Variability Climate Resilience Meteorological Forecasting Rainfall Deficit

Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green crackers' to balance cultural practices with air quality.

- BODY** | CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- BODY** | PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives
- FACT** | Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60% compared to traditional crackers
- PLACE** | Delhi Government's Winter Action Plan 2026-27 was announced on September 29, 2024

MAINS Q Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India.

USE: Precautionary Principle Right to Clean Environment Regulatory Compliance Pollution Mitigation Judicial Activism

Internal Security

4

Supreme Court takes action on Delhi's gang-rape cases, echoes 2012 Nirbhaya failures

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of recent gang-rape cases in Delhi to address systemic law enforcement failures and public safety lapses.

- POST** | Justice JB Pardiwala: Presiding judge in the Supreme Court's suo motu cognizance of Delhi rape cases.
- FACT** | 2012 Nirbhaya Case: A landmark case in India that led to significant legal reforms and the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013.
- BODY** | Suo Motu Cognizance: The power of the Supreme Court to take up a matter on its own motion without a formal petition.

MAINS Q Critically analyze the systemic challenges in law enforcement and public safety infrastructure in urban centers, and suggest measures to ensure victim safety and police accountability.

USE: Suo Motu Accountability Public Safety Law Enforcement Systemic Failure

RK Singh, India's Defence Secretary, stated at NDTV's Defence Conclave 2026 that the government

WHY IN NEWS Defence Secretary RK Singh announced the fast-tracking of a limited batch of Zorawar light tanks to counter China's Type-15 tanks along the LAC.

- S&T** | Zorawar: A light tank developed jointly by DRDO (CVRDE) and Larsen & Toubro (L&T).
- FACT** | The first batch of Zorawar tanks to be inducted consists of 18 units out of a total order of 59.
- PLACE** | The Zorawar tanks are specifically intended for use along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Ladakh.
- S&T** | Type-15: A light tank used by China, which the Zorawar is intended to counter.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of indigenous defense manufacturing and 'incremental induction' in strengthening India's border security against high-altitude threats.

USE: Atmanirbhar Bharat Indigenization LAC Security Incremental Induction Defense Procurement

Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Strategy, Busting 40 Modules Linked to Bhatti Network

WHY IN NEWS Home Minister Amit Shah announced the 'PRAHAAR' strategy and the dismantling of the Shahzad Bhatti network, highlighting a shift toward multi-agency coordination in counter-terrorism.

- ACT / BILL** | UAPA: Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act provides the legal framework for designating and prosecuting terrorist organizations.
- FACT** | The operation involved 350 arrests and over 100 FIRs across 15 Indian states.
- BODY** | Extradition Portal: A new government initiative launched to expedite the return of fugitives from foreign countries.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of multi-agency coordination and legislative frameworks like UAPA in strengthening India's counter-terrorism architecture.

USE: counter-terrorism inter-agency coordination UAPA national security extradition

Half of Indian cybercrime victims complain to police, 27% pay bribes

WHY IN NEWS The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 highlights systemic corruption and informal reliance among cybercrime victims, revealing that 27% of victims pay bribes to ensure case processing.

- REPORT** | SPIR 2026: Status of Policing in India Report published by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause
- FACT** | 27% of cybercrime victims report paying bribes for case handling
- FACT** | Recovery rates increase from 12% to 41% when bribes are paid
- FACT** | Rural poor (51%) and women (35%) are more likely to pay bribes than urban affluent (12%)

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in policing cybercrimes in India, with special reference to the role of corruption and the reliance on informal networks by vulnerable sections.

USE: systemic corruption informal networks digital divide grievance redressal socio-economic disparity



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